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United States Patent	12399012
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
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Information processing device, information processing method, and storage medium

Abstract

Based on expected position information on a vehicle obtained based on input information input from a sensor when the vehicle makes a predetermined movement with a position/orientation of the sensor maintained relative to the vehicle, and position information on the vehicle estimated based on input information input from the sensor after the vehicle makes the predetermined movement, information related to a change of the position/orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle after the vehicle makes the predetermined movement, from a held position/orientation, is output.

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Appl. No.:	17/178090
Filed:	February 17, 2021

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20210262804 A1	Aug. 26, 2021

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2020-027743	Feb. 21, 2020
JP	2020-204117	Dec. 09, 2020

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G01C21/20 (20060101); G01C25/00 (20060101); G07C5/08 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G01C21/20 (20130101); G01C25/00 (20130101); G07C5/0816 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G01C (21/20); G01C (25/00); G07C (5/0816); G07C (5/0825); G07C (5/0808)

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

Field of the Disclosure

(1) The aspect of the embodiments relates to technologies for estimating positions of a vehicle from information input from sensors.

Description of the Related Art

(2) There is a technology of estimating a position of a vehicle provided with a sensor that measure a distance between an object in the environment and the sensor, based on measurement information obtained by the sensor. The position of the vehicle is estimated with higher accuracy, with positional relationship between the vehicle and the sensor measured (calibration) in advance. In Japanese Patent Application Laid-Open No. 2009-279677, a sensor measures a reference target while a robot is moved by a predetermined amount so that the robot and the reference target satisfies a predetermined relative positional relationship between the robot and the reference target, and the measurement is repeated until the measurement result falls within an error range.

SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

(3) According to an aspect of the embodiments, a device includes an estimation unit configured to estimate, when a vehicle provided with a sensor makes a predetermined movement, first position information indicating a position of the vehicle based on input information input from the sensor, and an output unit configured to output, based on the estimated first position information and second position information indicating an expected position of the vehicle obtained based on input information input from the sensor when the vehicle makes the predetermined movement with a position/orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle maintained to be a position/orientation held in a holding unit, output information related to a change of the position/orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle after the vehicle makes the predetermined movement, from the position/orientation held in the holding unit.

(4) Further features of the disclosure will become apparent from the following description of exemplary embodiments with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating a system configuration example of an information processing system.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating a functional configuration example of the information processing device.
- (3) FIG. 3 is diagram illustrating an example of a hardware configuration of the information processing device.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a flowchart illustrating processing executed by the information processing device.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a flowchart illustrating processing executed by an amount-of-change acquisition unit.
- (6) FIGS. 6A and 6B are diagrams illustrating a method of acquiring an amount of change in an orientation parameter of a vehicle.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating processing executed by the amount-of-change acquisition unit.
- (8) FIGS. 8A and 8B are diagrams illustrating a method of acquiring an amount of change in a position parameter of the vehicle.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a flowchart illustrating processing executed by an information processing device.
- (10) FIG. 10 is a diagram illustrating an example of a graphical user interface (GUI).
- (11) FIG. 11 is a block diagram illustrating a functional configuration example of an information processing device.
- (12) FIG. 12 is a flowchart illustrating processing executed by an information processing device.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(13) Hereinafter, embodiments will be described in detail with reference to the attached drawings. Note, the following embodiments are not intended to limit the scope of the claimed disclosure. Multiple features are described in the embodiments, but limitation is not made a disclosure that requires all such features, and multiple such features may be combined as appropriate.

Furthermore, in the attached drawings, the same reference numerals are given to the same or similar configurations, and redundant description thereof is omitted.

- (14) The method according to Japanese Patent Application Laid-Open No. 2009-279677 does not take into account the fact that some unpredictable factor can change the relative positional relationship between a measurement device (sensor) and a robot (vehicle) to be an inappropriate positional relationship, meaning that an occurrence of such an event is difficult to detect. The occurrence of such an event results in the position of the vehicle becoming unable to be accurately estimated. An exemplary embodiment of the disclosure enables detection of deviation of the position/orientation of a sensor relative to a vehicle from calibrated position/orientation.
- (15) In a first exemplary embodiment, a case will be described where an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure is applied to an information processing system including a vehicle provided with a sensor that measures a distance between an object in the environment and the sensor. Specifically, the vehicle as used herein is assumed to be an unmanned carrier. When a vehicle plans a route using positions/orientations estimated based on measured values from a sensor and travels according to the plan, the measurement results from the sensor are converted into a format to be used in movement control of the vehicle. This conversion involves a relative positional relationship between the vehicle and the sensor. In view of this, the positional relationship between the vehicle and the sensor is measured (calibration) in advance, before the vehicle starts traveling. Here, the calibrated relative positional relationship between the sensor and the vehicle is defined as an appropriate positional relationship. However, the sensor can deviate from a calibrated position or

orientation while the vehicle is traveling. Specifically, the movement of the vehicle may create an inappropriate relative positional relationship between the sensor and the vehicle. When the actual physical relative positional relationship changes, the vehicle travels based on position estimation results of the vehicle including the change in the position/orientation of the sensor as noise. Thus, the vehicle might travel off the predetermined route. Therefore, in the present exemplary embodiment, the change in the positional relationship between the sensor and the vehicle as a result of straight movement of the vehicle by a predetermined distance is detected. Thus, a change in the relative positional relationship between the sensor and the vehicle is detected. When there is a change, a user is notified of the fact that the relative positional relationship between the sensor and the vehicle is inappropriate. Furthermore, a method performed by the user to correct the positional relationship between the sensor and the vehicle will be described. The sensor according to the present exemplary embodiment is a stereo camera (image sensor).

(16) FIG. 1 illustrates an example of a configuration of an information processing system **1** according to the present exemplary embodiment. The information processing system **1** includes a vehicle **10** that travels on a predetermined route, a sensor **12** that measures the shape of an object in the environment, an information processing device **11** that estimates the position/orientation of the sensor, a control device **13** that controls the vehicle, and an output device that outputs information about a deviation in the positional relationship. In the present exemplary embodiment, the vehicle **10** moves on a horizontal plane, and is, for example, assumed to be an unmanned carrier that carries a load.

(17) The movement control according to the present exemplary embodiment is about controlling a motor that is an actuator and about controlling a steering for changing the orientation of the wheels, which serve as the control device **13** of the vehicle **10**. Specifically, the control device **13** moves the vehicle **10** straight forward, backward, left, and right, and turn at a predetermined angle. The vehicle **10** is moved on the predetermined route by inputting movement control information to the control device **13**. The movement control information is information for controlling the control device **13**, and includes rotational torque of the wheels and a traveling direction. With rotation speed of the wheels and traveling direction set in advance as movement control information for a predetermined operation, the vehicle can be operated to move on a certain trail regardless of the position/orientation of the vehicle or the sensor.

(18) The position of the sensor **12** according to the present exemplary embodiment is defined by three parameters (X, Y, Z) representing the position of the sensor **12** in any world coordinate system defined in the real space. The orientation of the sensor **12** is defined by three parameters (roll, pitch, yaw) representing the orientation of the sensor **12**. These total of six parameters indicate the position/orientation of the sensor **12**. A three-dimensional coordinate system defined on the sensor with the optical axis of the sensor **12** being the Z axis, the horizontal direction of an image being the X axis, and the vertical direction being the Y axis is referred to as a sensor coordinate system.

(19) On the other hand, the position of the vehicle **10** according to the present exemplary embodiment is defined by two positional parameters (positions X and Y on the horizontal plane with respect to the floor of the real space) of the vehicle **10** on any world coordinate system defined in the real space. The orientation of the vehicle **10** is defined by one orientation parameter (a rotation direction on the horizontal plane with respect to the floor of the real space). The position/orientation of the vehicle **10** is defined by these total of three parameters. A two-dimensional coordinate system defined on the vehicle **10**, with a traveling direction of the vehicle **10** being the Y axis and a direction orthogonal to the traveling direction being the X axis, is referred to as a vehicle coordinate system. The vehicle **10** according to the present exemplary embodiment is assumed to move on the horizontal plane.

(20) The relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** according to the present exemplary embodiment is the relative position/orientation between the origin of the sensor

coordinate system and the origin of the vehicle coordinate system, and is indicated by the total of six parameters consisting of the three parameters indicating the position and the three parameters indicating the orientation. Using this relative position/orientation, the position/orientation on the sensor coordinate system and the one on the vehicle coordinate system is converted to each other. This positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** is assumed to have been calibrated in advance using a known technology. With the following processing, when an orientation (position) of the sensor **12** changes from that in an initial state due to vibration of the vehicle **10** or some sort of external cause, a change from the positional relationship that has been known through the calibration preformed in advance is detected.

(21) FIG. **2** is a diagram illustrating an example of a functional configuration of an information processing device **11** according to the present exemplary embodiment. The information processing device **11** includes a movement control unit **111**, a position/orientation estimation unit **112**, a position/orientation conversion unit **113**, an amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**, a calibration determination unit **115**, a relative position/orientation calibration unit **116**, and an output unit **117**. The position/orientation estimation unit **112** is connected to the sensor **12**. The movement control unit **111** is connected to the control device **13**. The information processing device **11** is connected to the control device **13** that controls the movement of the vehicle **10** and the output device **14** that outputs information about the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10**.

(22) The movement control unit **111** generates movement control information for controlling the movement of the vehicle **10**, and outputs the movement control information to the control device **13** and the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**.

(23) The position/orientation estimation unit **112** estimates the position/orientation of the sensor **12** based on a measurement value obtained from the sensor **12**, and outputs the position/orientation of the sensor **12** to the position/orientation conversion unit **113**. The sensor **12** is, for example, a stereo camera, and acquires image information as input information. The input information from the sensor **12** will be hereinafter described as measurement information or a measurement value for the sake of convenience. The position/orientation conversion unit **113** converts the position/orientation of the sensor **12**, input by the position/orientation estimation unit **112**, from the sensor coordinate system to the vehicle coordinate system, and outputs the result to the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. The amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** outputs an amount of change in the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10**, based on the result of the conversion input from the position/orientation conversion unit **113** and a deviation of the position/orientation of the vehicle **10** as a result of a predetermined operation known in advance. The amount of change thus acquired is output to the calibration determination unit **115** or the output unit **117**. The calibration determination unit **115** determines whether the calibration is to be executed, using the amount of change in the relative position/orientation as an input. The determination result is output to the relative position/orientation calibration unit **116**. The relative position/orientation calibration unit **116** calibrates the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** based on the result of determining whether the calibration is to be executed. The output unit **117** outputs output information indicating whether the positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** after the predetermined operation is the held positional relationship, based on the amount of change in the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10**. Specifically, the output information output to the output device **14** corresponds to a difference in the position of the vehicle **10** obtained based on the position (first position information) of the vehicle **10** estimated by the position/orientation conversion unit **113**, and a predicted position (second position information) of the vehicle **10** after the predetermined operation associated with the predetermined operation. The second position information is a position of the vehicle **10** expected to be obtained when the vehicle **10** performs the predetermined operation with the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10**.

maintained. With this configuration, a deviation of the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** measured in advance can be detected before the traveling starts or during the traveling, and the user can be notified of the deviation.

(24) FIG. **3** is a diagram illustrating a hardware configuration of the information processing device **11**. A central processing unit (CPU) **H11** controls different devices connected to a system bus **H20**. A read only memory (ROM) **H12** stores a basic input/output system (BIOS) program and a boot program. A random access memory (RAM) **H13** is used as a main storage device of the CPU **H11**. An external memory **H14** stores a program that the information processing device **11** runs. An input unit **H15** is a keyboard, a mouse, and/or a robot controller, and executes processing related to input of information. A display unit **H16** outputs a calculation result, obtained by the information processing device **11**, to a display device in response to an instruction from the CPU **H11**. The display device may be of any type, such as a liquid crystal display device, a projector, or a light emitting diode (LED) indicator. A communication interface **H17** performs information communication over a network. The communication interface may be of any type, such as Ethernet®, universal serial bus (USB), serial communications, and wireless communications. An I/O **H17** receives an image from a sensor **H18**. A sensor **H18** is the sensor **12** described above. A control device **H19** is the control device **13** described above.

(25) FIG. **4** is a flowchart illustrating a processing procedure according to the present exemplary embodiment. The processing includes initialization step **S101**, movement control step **S102**, position/orientation estimation step **S103**, position/orientation conversion step **S104**, amount-of-change acquisition step **S105**, calibration determination steps **S106** and **S107**, relative position/orientation calibration step **S108**, and system end determination step **S109**. The processing illustrated in the flowchart in FIG. **4** is executed by the CPU **H11** in FIG. **3**, which is a computer, based on a computer program stored in the external memory **H14**. In the following description, the description of the word step is omitted with S provided as the first letter for each step.

(26) In step **S101**, the system is initialized. Specifically, an operable state of the information processing device **11** is achieved with a program read from the external memory **H14**. Parameters of devices connected to the information processing device **11** and the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** are read onto the RAM **H13**. Each control device of the vehicle **10** is started to be in an operable/controllable state.

(27) In step **S102**, the movement control unit **111** causes the vehicle **10** to perform a predetermined operation based on the control information for the vehicle **10** to perform the predetermined operation. Here, the predetermined operation is an operation of moving straight by a predetermined distance. The control information, such as that indicating how many meters the vehicle **10** moves forward, may be acquired or generated. In the present exemplary embodiment, control is performed with the traveling direction fixed to forward (or backward) so that the vehicle **10** moves straight. Thus, the orientation (direction) of the sensor **12** can be detected without involving a manual operation.

(28) In step **S103**, the position/orientation estimation unit **112** estimates the position/orientation of the sensor **12** based on the measurement information measured by the sensor **12** at a second time point after the predetermined operation. When the sensor **12** is an image sensor, the measurement information is image information. Here, the trail of the position/orientation of the sensor **12** is estimated based on the measurement information measured by the sensor **12** between a first time point when the predetermined operation has started and the second time point after the predetermined operation. The position/orientation of the sensor **12** thus estimated is referred to as first position information. In the present exemplary embodiment, simultaneous localization and mapping (SLAM) technology is used. One specific example of SLAM processing will be described. SLAM is a method using feature points detected on an image to estimate the position and orientation of a sensor or the like. For example, the information processing device **11** holds, as map information about a scene in which the vehicle **10** provided with the sensor **12** travels,

information about a group of three-dimensional points representing a structural feature of a wall and a still object in the scene. Specifically, the information about the group of three-dimensional points in the scene is three-dimensional coordinates of feature points in the world coordinate system. In the present exemplary embodiment, the map information about the scene is generated in advance based on an image obtained by imaging the shape of an object in the environment while the vehicle **10** is traveling, and is stored in a storage device. Based on an input image and the map information, the information processing device **11** minimizes a difference (reprojection error) between a position of a feature point (edge characteristic indicating a shape of a periphery) on the input image, and a position of the feature point projected on the input image using the position/orientation of the sensor **12** at the time of capturing the input image. Thus, the position/orientation of the sensor **12** is estimated. Any other methods of estimating the position/orientation of the sensor **12** from the measurement information may be employed.

(29) Here, a method proposed by Engel et al. (J. Engel, T. Schops, and D. Cremers. LSD-SLAM: Large-Scale Direct Monocular SLAM. ECCV, 2014) is used. With this method, self-position estimation and map generation in a wide area environment such as outdoors are concurrently performed. When the vehicle **10** is in a stopped state before it starts moving, the position/orientation estimation unit **112** outputs the origin of the sensor coordinate system as the position/orientation of the sensor **12**. While the vehicle **10** is performing the predetermined operation, the position/orientation of the sensor **12** is continuously measured at predetermined time intervals or distance intervals, and all the pieces of measurement information are output to the position/orientation conversion unit **113**. The measurement information is array data on the six position and orientation parameters.

(30) In step **S104**, the position/orientation conversion unit **113** converts the trail of the position/orientation of the sensor **12**, input by the position/orientation estimation unit **112**, from the sensor coordinate system to the vehicle coordinate system. Specifically, a change in (trail of) the estimated position/orientation of the sensor **12** is converted into the position/orientation of the vehicle **10** based on the known positional relationship. More specifically, first of all, axes (X, Y, Z) of a coordinate system for the three position parameters and the three orientation parameters are aligned with those of the vehicle coordinate system, by rotating or translating the position and orientation of the sensor **12**, based on the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** held in a holding unit such as the RAM **H13**. Next, the six position/orientation parameters of the sensor **12** are reduced to three parameters because the vehicle coordinate system has three degrees of freedom. Specifically, data that cannot exist on the vehicle coordinate system is deleted from the array data on the position information. Among the position parameters, data about the Z axis that is the vertical direction is deleted. On the other hand, among the orientation parameters, data about roll (X axis) and pitch (Y axis) other than that about yaw (Z axis) corresponding to the rotation direction on the horizontal plane is deleted. A plurality of pieces of position information about the sensor **12**, converted to be on the vehicle coordinate system, is output to the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. When the vehicle **10** moves straight, the position of the vehicle **10** at the first time point when the predetermined operation has started and the position of the vehicle **10** at the second time point after the predetermined operation may be acquired based on the positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10**. This enables estimation to be performed with calculation simpler than that in a case of estimating the trail of movement of the vehicle **10**, and thus to be performed with a smaller processing load. When the trail of movement of the vehicle **10** is used, an amount of change in the orientation of the sensor **12** can be estimated with a higher accuracy.

(31) In step **S105**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** uses the plurality of pieces of position information about the sensor **12** input from the position/orientation conversion unit **113**, to acquire an amount of change between the relative position/orientation held in the RAM **H13** and the actual physical relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12**. Specifically, the

position/orientation conversion unit **113** acquires a result of converting the position (first position information) of the vehicle **10** or the sensor **12** after the predetermined operation is acquired from measurement information measured by the sensor **12** when the vehicle **10** performs the predetermined operation. Then, the predicted position (second position information) of the vehicle **10** or the sensor **12** when the predetermined operation is performed in the positional relationship set in advance is compared with the position of the vehicle **10** or the sensor **12** after the predetermined operation. When the first position information and the second position information indicate that a difference in the position of the vehicle **10** or the sensor **12** does not exceed a predetermined threshold, the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** can be regarded as not being changed from a value set in advance. When the vehicle **10** moves straight as in the present exemplary embodiment, the amount of change in the orientation parameter of the relative position/orientation is obtained. The details of the processing will be described.

(32) FIG. 5 is a flowchart illustrating processing executed by the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. In step **S201**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** determines whether the amount of a trail represented by the position information input by the position/orientation conversion unit **113** is sufficient to estimate an amount of change in the orientation of the sensor **12**. For example, the Euclidean distance between the origin (0,0) and a position parameter (X,Y) of the latest position/orientation is obtained from the position information. If the distance is equal to or greater than a predetermined threshold (YES in step **S201**), the amount of data about the position/orientation is determined to be sufficient, and the processing proceeds to step **S202**. If the amount is insufficient (NO in step **S201**), the amount-of-change acquisition processing is terminated without acquiring the amount of change. A larger amount of position information allows the amount of change in the orientation of the sensor **12** to be estimated with a higher accuracy. This step may be skipped if the amount of change in the orientation of the sensor **12** is obtained by using the positions of the vehicle **10** respectively at the first time point when the predetermined operation has started and the second time point when the predetermined operation has ended.

(33) Now, the subsequent processing will be described with reference to FIGS. 6A and 6B. FIG. 6A is a diagram illustrating position information about the sensor **12** in the vehicle coordinate system mapped on a two-dimensional plane. The vehicle **10** provided with the sensor **12** moves straight in the direction illustrated in the figure by a predetermined distance. The origin **D101** of the vehicle coordinate system is also the initial position of the sensor **12**. Black circles **D102** are results of plotting respective position parameters included in the position information about the sensor **12**. The trail is indicated by plotting on the vehicle coordinate system, positions traversed by the vehicle **10** between the first time point when the vehicle **10** starts the predetermined operation, and the second time point after the movement through execution of the predetermined operation.

(34) In step **S202**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** estimates first position information indicating the position of the vehicle **10** after the predetermined operation, from the measurement information measured when the vehicle **10** performs the predetermined operation, based on the positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10**. The first position information may be a trail of the sensor **12**, and is acquired in an approximate straight line using all the position parameters included in the position information about the sensor **12** as inputs. FIGS. 6A and 6B illustrate this approximate straight line **D103**. When the trail of the vehicle **10** is used, a change in the orientation of the sensor **12** indicated by **D104** can be detected more accurately. To maintain the detection accuracy of the change in the orientation of the sensor **12**, the approximate straight line **D1003** may not include points where the position has failed to be estimated or measured accurately. For example, the position information about the sensor **12** or the vehicle **10** acquired with the reliability falling below a predetermined value is controlled so as not to be used for estimating the approximate straight line. This step may be skipped if a change in the orientation is detected based on the position of the sensor **12** at the first time point when the predetermined operation has started, and the position of the sensor **12** after the predetermined operation. Such a case involves a smaller

amount of information, thus involving a smaller processing load.

(35) In step **S203**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** outputs a difference in the sensor position based on the first position information and second position information indicating the predicted position of the vehicle **10** (sensor **12**) associated with the predetermined operation. In other words, an amount of change in the orientation of the sensor **12** is acquired based on the positions (trail) of the vehicle **10** (sensor **12**) before and after the predetermined operation. Specifically, an angle **D104** between the approximate straight line **D103** and the Y axis in FIGS. **6A** and **6B** is acquired. In the vehicle coordinate system, the Y axis direction is the moving direction of the vehicle **10**. Thus, when the vehicle **10** moves straight, the X coordinate of the position parameter should always be 0 (predicted position). Therefore, a deviation of the approximate straight line of the position information from the Y axis indicates an erroneous conversion of the position information between coordinate systems (from the sensor coordinate system to the vehicle coordinate system) performed by the position/orientation conversion unit **113**. This erroneous conversion is caused by a change from the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** held in the RAM **H13**, that is, a change in the orientation parameter of the sensor **12**. The amount of change in the orientation parameter corresponds to the angle between the approximate straight line of the position information and the Y axis. The angle between these two straight lines is calculated using a trigonometric function. At this point, the processing in step **S105** is completed.

(36) The amount of change in the orientation of the sensor **12** acquired as described above is output to the calibration determination unit **115**. In step **S106**, the calibration determination unit **115** acquires the amount of change from the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. If the acquired amount of change is equal to or greater than a predetermined threshold, it is determined that calibration is to be executed for the relative position/orientation. Otherwise, it is determined that the calibration is to be not executed. In step **S107**, if the calibration determination unit **115** determines that the calibration is to be executed (YES in step **S107**), the processing proceeds to **S108**. Otherwise (NO in step **S107**), the processing skips the step and directly proceeds to step **S109**. The determination result thus obtained is input to the output unit **117**, and the output information is presented to the user through the predetermined output device **14**. For example, if it is determined that the calibration is to be executed (YES in step **S107**), output information notifying the user of deviation of attachment position/orientation of the sensor **12** is output. The output device **14** and the output information will be described.

(37) In step **S108**, the relative position/orientation calibration unit **116** corrects the relative position/orientation to make it match the actual physical relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12**, based on the amount of change in the relative position/orientation acquired by the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. Specifically, the amount of change in the orientation of the sensor **12** is estimated from the first position information, and the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** is updated based on the amount of change. More specifically, the angle corresponding to the amount of change is subtracted from the parameter corresponding to Yaw (Z axis) in the vehicle coordinates among the orientation parameters of the relative position/orientation. The relative position/orientation after the calibration is held in the RAM **H13** in an overwritten manner.

(38) In step **S109**, whether the system ends is determined. Specifically, the calibration of the relative position/orientation is determined to be complete and the system ends (YES in step **S109**), when the amount of change acquired by the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** is equal to or smaller than the threshold, or when the input unit **H15** receives a termination instruction from the user. Otherwise (NO in step **S109**), the processing returns to step **S101**, and continues.

(39) In the first exemplary embodiment, the position/orientation is measured based on an image acquired from the sensor **12** when the vehicle **10** moves straight. Then, an amount of change in the orientation parameter of the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** is

acquired, based on the position information including positions/orientations at a plurality of time points. Furthermore, the orientation parameter is corrected from the acquired amount of change. With this configuration, the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** can be corrected without using a highly accurate movement amount of the vehicle **10**, and the change in the relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the position/orientation estimation device can be easily corrected.

(40) (Modification 1-1)

(41) In the first exemplary embodiment, the position/orientation estimation unit **112** employs the SLAM technology using a camera to measure the position/orientation. However, the sensor **12** used in combination with the SLAM technology is not limited to the camera, and may be any sensor. The position/orientation may be measured with a combination of the SLAM technology and an active range sensor based on as LiDAR, Time of Flight, pattern light projection, and the like.

(42) The position/orientation estimation unit **112** is not limited to the SLAM technology, and may employ any approach as long as the position/orientation can be measured. For example, a method based on radio field intensity measurement in wireless communications such as Wi-Fi may be employed. Furthermore, a method using a difference in sensing time of a magnetic tracking sensor or a multitude of optical sensors may be employed. A method of performing model fitting based on computer-aided design (CAD) data, using an image acquired by a camera such as a surveillance camera installed at a certain position may be employed.

(43) (Modification 1-2)

(44) In the first exemplary embodiment, the position/orientation conversion unit **113** converts the position/orientation of the sensor **12** from the sensor coordinate system to the vehicle coordinate system and outputs the result to the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. However, the positions/orientations may be integrated on any coordinate system, as long as the positions/orientations are integrated on a single coordinate system when the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** acquires the relative position/orientation. For example, when the positions/orientations are integrated on the sensor coordinate system, the following processing may be executed. The position/orientation conversion unit **113** converts the position/orientation of the vehicle **10**, estimated based on the movement control information acquired from the movement control unit **111**, from the vehicle coordinate system to the sensor coordinate system, and outputs the result to the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. On the other hand, the position/orientation of the sensor **12** obtained from the position/orientation estimation unit **112** may be directly output in the sensor coordinate system to the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. Then, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** may acquire the amount of change based on the positions/orientations of both the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** on the sensor coordinate system.

(45) (Modification 1-3)

(46) In the first exemplary embodiment, the information processing system **1** is not limited to an unmanned carrier (vehicle). For example, the information processing system **1** may be an autonomous vehicle or an autonomous mobile robot, and the movement control described in the present exemplary embodiment may be applied to these. The present exemplary embodiment may be applied to an unmanned aerial vehicle **10'** as illustrated in FIG. **8B**. Specifically, the vehicle is a drone. In a case of an aerial vehicle, the inclination of the sensor **12** can be detected from, for example, a downward movement in the direction of gravity (Z axis) and/or an upward movement in the direction opposite to the direction of gravity by a predetermined distance. Alternatively, the present exemplary embodiment may be applied to a robot arm having an arm portion provided with a sensor.

(47) (Modification 1-4)

(48) The output unit **117** outputs output information indicating whether the positional relationship after the predetermined operation matches or does not match the held positional relationship, based on the trail (first position information) of the vehicle **10** estimated after the predetermined operation

and a predicted trail (second position information) of the vehicle **10** after the predetermined operation. For example, if the amount of change in the position/orientation of the sensor **12** or the vehicle **10** acquired by the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** is larger than a predetermined threshold, output information indicating that the positional relationship between sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** matches or does not match the positional relationship held is output to the output device **14**. For example, if a lamp of three colors red, yellow, and green is used as a presentation unit, presentation is made in red used to indicate that the amount of change in the relative position/orientation is equal to or greater than the predetermined threshold, and in green used to indicate that the amount of change is smaller than the threshold. Thus, the amount-of-change acquisition result can be visualized for the user. Thresholds may be set for respective levels, so that the notification method may vary depending on which threshold range the amount of change is included in. For example, a first threshold corresponding to a level at which the calibration is definitely to be executed, and a second threshold for notifying that a change from the initial position/orientation has occurred but the change has a limited impact on the position estimation are set in advance. For example, red is lit if the amount of change in the position/orientation of the sensor **12** acquired is equal to or greater than the first threshold. Yellow is lit if the amount of change is smaller than the first threshold and is equal to or greater than the second threshold. Green is lit if the amount of change is smaller than the second threshold. Specifically, if a difference between the positions of the vehicle **10** indicated by the first measurement information and the second measurement information is greater than the first threshold, the output information is output to a first output device. If the difference between the positions of the vehicle **10** indicated by the first measurement information and the second measurement information is greater than the second threshold smaller than the first threshold, the output information is output to a second output device. The output device **14** may be an LED lamp or may be a liquid crystal display, as long as information about the amount-of-change acquisition result can be presented to the user. The output device may be an audio output device such as a speaker, and may be configured to provide certain audible information (such as an alarm sound or a melody) based on a map update status. The output device may be a projection device. For example, if the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** is detected to be inappropriate, the proper attachment position/orientation of the sensor **12** may be projected by a projection device or a display device. Specifically, the proper position/orientation of the sensor **12** may be projected by a projector, so that the attachment position/orientation of the sensor **12** can be presented to the user in an easily understandable manner.

(49) (Modification 1-5)

(50) The vehicle **10** may be set to automatically perform a predetermined operation at a predetermined timing. For example, the vehicle **10** may be configured to perform a predetermined operation of moving straight by a predetermined distance and then immediately coming back, at points of time the information processing system **1** starts or ends. This enables a change in the positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12** to be detected before the vehicle **10** starts autonomous traveling using the sensor **12**, whereby the vehicle **10** can be controlled more safely. A change in the orientation of the sensor **12** results in moving along a trail **D103'** twice as illustrated in FIG. **6B**. No change in the orientation of the sensor **12** results in a trail of moving on the Y axis by a predetermined distance and coming back. With the movement along the same trail occurring twice, the amount of measurement information is increased and an amount of change in the orientation of the sensor **12** can be more accurately acquired. When the vehicle **10** starts or stops, the vehicle **10** may be set to travel to a predetermination location (a charging spot or a standby space, for example). In such a case, the amount of change in the orientation of the sensor **12** described above may be acquired at a timing when the vehicle **10** becomes close to the predetermined location (a timing when the position of the vehicle **10** enters a predetermined range from a target location). With the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the

vehicle **10** thus checked at a predetermined timing, the position of the vehicle **10** can be measured more accurately and more stably. With the trigger set at a timing enabling the user to immediately recognize the detection result, the processing described above can be executed at any appropriate timing. Thus, the relative positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** can be easily detected to be in an inappropriate positional relationship.

(51) In the first exemplary embodiment, the relative position/orientation of the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12** are corrected, based on a result of acquiring a relative amount of change in the orientation parameters of the sensor **12** and the vehicle, based on the position information about the sensor **12** obtained with the vehicle **10** moving along a straight line moving trail. According to a second exemplary embodiment, the relative position parameters of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** can also be corrected. Thus, in the second exemplary embodiment, the relative position/orientation is corrected using a result of acquiring an amount of change in the relative position parameters of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** based on the position information about the sensor **12** obtained with the vehicle **10** turning.

(52) The diagram illustrating the configuration according to the present exemplary embodiment is the same as FIG. 2 illustrating the configuration of the information processing device **11** described in the first exemplary embodiment, and thus the description thereof will be omitted. The hardware configuration may also be the same as that in the first exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 3. The diagram illustrating the processing procedure according to the present exemplary embodiment is the same as FIG. 4 illustrating the processing procedure performed by the information processing device **11** described in the first exemplary embodiment, and thus the description thereof will be omitted. Processing procedures different from those in the first exemplary embodiment will be described, and description on the other procedures, which are regarded as being the same as those in FIG. 4, will be omitted.

(53) In step **S102**, the movement control unit **111** performs movement control on the vehicle **10** by outputting, to the control device **13**, movement control information for turning the vehicle **10** by a predetermined rotation amount. With the movement control according to the present exemplary embodiment, the vehicle **10** makes a rotary motion with which the orientation parameter is changed, with no movement of the position parameter from the origin that is the initial position on the vehicle coordinate system.

(54) In step **S105**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** uses the position information about the sensor **12** input by the position/orientation conversion unit **113**, to acquire an amount of change between the relative position/orientation held in the RAM **H13** and the actual physical relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12**. If the vehicle **10** makes the rotary motion involving a change in the orientation of the vehicle according to the present exemplary embodiment, the amount of change in the position parameter of the relative position/orientation is obtained.

(55) FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating a detailed procedure of the amount-of-change acquisition processing. In step **S301**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** determines whether the amount of positions/orientations in the position information input from the position/orientation conversion unit **113** is sufficient to acquire the amount of change. The position/orientation estimation unit **112** measures the position/orientation at constant time intervals, and thus the movement time is proportional to the amount of data about the position/orientation. If the movement time is equal to or longer than a predetermined time period (YES in step **S301**), the amount of data is determined to be sufficient, and the processing proceeds to step **S302**. If the amount is insufficient (NO in step **S301**), the amount-of-change acquisition processing is terminated without acquiring the amount of change.

(56) Now, the subsequent processing will be described with reference to FIG. 8A. FIG. 8A is a diagram illustrating position information about the sensor **12** on the vehicle coordinate system mapped on a two-dimensional plane. The origin **D201** of the vehicle coordinate system is also the

initial position of the sensor **12**. Black circles **D202** are results of plotting respective position parameters included in the position information. The vehicle **10** performs an operation of turning in the illustrated moving direction.

(57) In step **S302**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** obtains an approximate circle using all the position parameters included in the position information about the sensor **12** as inputs. In the present exemplary embodiment, the rotary motion involving a change in the orientation parameter is performed, meaning that the position parameter is not supposed to change from the origin.

However, a change in the position parameter of the relative position/orientation results in a trail approximate to a circle obtained with the position information about the sensor **12**. Thus, the approximate circle is obtained. FIGS. **6A** and **6B** illustrate this approximate circle **D203**.

(58) In step **S303**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** acquires a difference between the center coordinates of the approximate circle and the initial position coordinates. Since the initial position coordinates are the origin, the difference indicates the center coordinates of the approximate circle obtained in the position information, and thus indicates the amount of change. In FIGS. **8A** and **8B**, since the center coordinates **D204** of the approximate circle of the position information is shifted from the origin along the X axis, and thus indicates a change in the X coordinate of the position parameter. The amount of change acquired as described above is output to the calibration determination unit **115**.

(59) In step **S108**, the relative position/orientation calibration unit **116** corrects the relative position/orientation to make it match the actual physical relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12**, based on the amount of change in the relative position/orientation acquired by the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**, as in the first exemplary embodiment. Specifically, the amount of change is subtracted from the parameters in the X/Y axis direction on the vehicle coordinate system, among the position parameters of the relative position/orientation. In the example illustrated in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**, since the change in the X axis direction has occurred, the X coordinate is subtracted by the amount of change. The relative position/orientation after the calibration is held in the RAM **H13** in an overwritten manner.

(60) In the second exemplary embodiment, when the vehicle **10** makes a rotary motion which changes the orientation, the amount of change in the relative position parameters of the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12** is acquired from the position information about the sensor **12**. Furthermore, the relative position/orientation is corrected using the amount of change thus acquired. With this configuration, the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** can be corrected without using a highly accurate movement amount of the vehicle **10**, and the change in the relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the position/orientation estimation device can be easily corrected.

(61) (Modification 2-1)

(62) In the first and second exemplary embodiments, the movement control unit **111** performs the movement control to move the vehicle **10** straight (first exemplary embodiment) and turn it (second exemplary embodiment). However, the movement control is not limited to those. Any movement control can be performed on the vehicle **10** as long as the movement trail includes the straight movement, turning, or both. For example, a U-turn, an L-shaped movement, or a movement trail drawing a rectangle may be implemented. With movement control for such a combination of the straight movement and turning, in the trail obtained from the position information about the sensor **12**, the straight line segment and non-straight line segment (for example, portions where the vehicle **10** takes a turn or turns back) are separated from each other. The amount-of-change acquisition processing according to the first and the second exemplary embodiment is applied to each of the separated trails, so that the amount of change in each of the position and orientation parameters of the relative position/orientation is acquired for each of the separated trails.

(63) (Modification 2-2)

(64) In the first and the second exemplary embodiments, the movement control unit **111** outputs the

movement control information to the control device **13**, to move the vehicle **10** itself. However, the vehicle **10** itself may not move, as long as the vehicle **10** can move along a predetermined movement trail. For example, the vehicle **10** may be placed on a device such as a moving stage or a turntable to move or rotate. In this case, the measurement information can be acquired by the sensor **12** without controlling the vehicle **10** itself, whereby a change in the positional relationship between the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** can be detected more accurately.

(65) In the first and the second exemplary embodiments, when the movement control is performed to cause a predetermined movement of the vehicle **10** such as straight movement and turn, the amount of change in the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** is acquired based on the position/orientation of the sensor **12**, and the relative position/orientation is corrected based on the amount of change. In a third exemplary embodiment, a method is further described in which the vehicle **10** automatically calibrates the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10**, while autonomously traveling on a predetermined route. In the present exemplary embodiment, a particular case is described where a section in which the predetermined movement is performed is set in advance together with the route information. The predetermined movement section according to the present exemplary embodiment is a section in which a predetermined movement such as straight movement and turning occurs.

(66) The system configuration example according to the present exemplary embodiment is the same as that in the first exemplary embodiment, and includes the information processing device **11** and the vehicle **10** including the sensor **12** as illustrated in FIG. **1**. The hardware configuration according to the present exemplary embodiment is the same as that in the first exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. **3**. The functions of each hardware are the same as those in the first exemplary embodiment and thus the description thereof is omitted. FIG. **11** illustrates an example of a functional configuration according to the present exemplary embodiment. The configuration is different from that in the first exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. **2**, in that a movement route holding unit **216** and a predetermined movement determination unit **217** are provided. Here, only the parts different from the first exemplary embodiment will be described, and the description of the same parts will be omitted.

(67) The movement route holding unit **216** holds route information for the vehicle **10** to travel on a predetermined route and predetermined movement section information. These pieces of information include the destination and a via point on the traveling route of the vehicle **10** as well as the start point and the end point of the predetermined movement section, and are array data on three position/orientation parameters of the vehicle **10**.

(68) The movement control unit **211** generates movement control information using the route information held by the movement route holding unit **216** as an input, and outputs the movement control information to the control device **13**. Alternatively, the movement control information generated by an external device or preset movement control information is acquired, and the vehicle **10** is controlled based on the movement control information thus acquired.

(69) The predetermined movement determination unit **217** determines whether the current position of the vehicle **10** is within or outside the predetermined movement section, by using, as inputs, the position/orientation of the sensor **12** input from the position/orientation conversion unit **113** and the predetermined movement section information held by the movement route holding unit **216**. A result of the determination is output to the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**.

(70) FIG. **9** is a flowchart illustrating the processing procedure according to the present exemplary embodiment. The description on processing that is the same as that in FIG. **4** illustrating the processing procedure performed by the information processing device **11** according to the first exemplary embodiment will be omitted. The description is given of steps **S302**, **S305**, **S306**, and **S309** different from the processing procedure according to the first exemplary embodiment.

(71) In step **S302**, the movement control unit **111** performs the movement control on the vehicle **10** by acquiring the movement control information for traveling along the designated route based on

the route information held by the movement route holding unit **216**, and outputting the movement control information to the control device **13**.

(72) In step **S305**, the predetermined movement determination unit **217** determines whether the vehicle **10** is within or outside the predetermined movement section. Whether the current position of the vehicle **10** is within or outside the predetermined movement section is determined based on the position/orientation of the sensor **12** input from the position/orientation conversion unit **113** and the predetermined movement section information held by the movement route holding unit **216**. If the current position is within the predetermined movement section, the determination, together with information about the type of the predetermined movement, is output. The information about the type of the predetermined movement is, for example, a movement pattern including straight movement described in the first exemplary embodiment and turning described in the second exemplary embodiment. If the position of the vehicle **10** is within the predetermined movement section but with a short traveling time in the predetermined movement section, the amount of data about the position/orientation in the position information about the sensor **12** may not be sufficient to acquire the amount of change. Thus, false is output as the determination result even if the current position is within the predetermined movement section with the vehicle **10** that has not traveled in the predetermined movement section for a predetermined period of time or longer.

(73) In step **S306**, if the determination result obtained by the predetermined movement determination unit **217** is true (YES in step **S306**), the processing proceeds to step **S107**. Otherwise (NO in step **S306**), the processing skips a few steps to directly proceed to step **S310**. In step **S107**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** uses the position information about the sensor **12** input by the position/orientation conversion unit **113**, to acquire an amount of change between the relative position/orientation held in the RAM **H13** and the actual physical relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12**. At this point, a method of acquiring the amount of change is determined based on the information about the type of the predetermined movement input from the predetermined movement determination unit **217**. For example, the method according to the first exemplary embodiment is performed if the type of the predetermined movement is straight movement, and the method according to the second exemplary embodiment is performed if the type of the predetermined movement is turning.

(74) In step **S309**, the relative position/orientation calibration unit **216** corrects the relative position/orientation to make it match the actual physical relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12**, based on the amount of change in the relative position/orientation acquired by the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. In the present exemplary embodiment, the correction is made according to the parameters acquired by the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. Specifically, if the type of the predetermined movement is straight movement, the orientation parameter is corrected, and if the type is turning, the position parameter is corrected.

(75) In the third exemplary embodiment, whether the current position is within the predetermined movement section is determined with the section in which a predetermined movement occurs set together with the route information for the autonomous traveling of the vehicle **10**. Based on a result of the determination, the acquisition and correction of the amount of change in the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** are dynamically switched. With this configuration, the vehicle **10** can correct the relative position/orientation while autonomously traveling, and a change in the relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the position/orientation estimation device can be easily corrected.

(76) (Modification 3-1)

(77) In the third exemplary embodiment, the movement route holding unit **216** holds route information for the vehicle **10** to travel on a predetermined route and predetermined movement section information. Based on the predetermined movement section information, the predetermined movement determination unit **217** determines whether the current position is within or outside the predetermined movement section relative to the position of vehicle **10**. However, this should not be

understood in a limiting sense, and any configuration may be employed as long as the predetermined movement determination unit **217** can determine whether the current position is within or outside the predetermined movement section, based on the information held by the movement route holding unit **216**. For example, a method may be employed in which the movement route holding unit **216** holds a history of the movement trail of the vehicle **10**, and the predetermined movement determination unit **217** extracts a section involving a predetermined movement such as straight movement and turning by performing least squares fitting on the history of the movement trail.

(78) Furthermore, the predetermined movement determination unit **217** may make the determination using other information instead of the information held by the movement route holding unit **216**. For example, the movement trail of the vehicle may be obtained using a sensor **12** such as a surveillance camera enabling the vehicle **10** to be monitored from a third person's point of view. Then, whether the current position is within or outside the predetermined movement section and the type of the predetermined movement may be determined based on the movement trail.

(79) The output unit **117** may output output information related to the calibration of the relative position/orientation, such as the predetermined movement section, the amount of change in the relative position/orientation, and the calibration parameter. FIG. **10** illustrates a graphical user interface (GUI) **100** in an example where a display is used as the output device **14** to present the route information and the predetermined movement section information about the vehicle **10** as well as the result of acquiring the amount of change in the relative position/orientation and the calibration parameter.

(80) A GUI **G110** presents the movement route information and the predetermined movement section information about the vehicle **10**. A vehicle **G111** is autonomously traveling between a start point **G112** and an end point **G113** on the travel route. An arrow line between the start point **G112** and the end point **G113** is the travel route, and a solid arrow line in particular indicates the predetermined movement section.

(81) A GUI **G120** is configured to select the type of movement control on a vehicle **10**. Specifically, for the movement control of turning the vehicle **10**, the type is selected as one for a case in which the orientation parameter changes as described in the second exemplary embodiment, or one for a case where both the position parameter and the orientation parameter change as in a case of automobile.

(82) A GUI **G130** is configured to present the result of acquiring the amount of change in the relative position/orientation. A part **G131** displays numerical values of the position and the orientation separately as the amount of change in the relative position/orientation acquired. A part **G132** displays each axis (solid arrow lines) of the coordinate system as a result of adding the acquired amount of change to the current vehicle coordinate system (dotted arrow lines). This makes it possible to visually recognize the amount of change in the relative position/orientation. The user can determine whether to correct the attachment position/orientation of the sensor **12**. The example illustrated in FIG. **10** is where the orientation (angle) is changed.

(83) A GUI **G140** is used for the user to adjust the calibration of relative position/orientation. In a part **G141**, the auto calibration during the traveling can be enabled by clicking a checkbox. In a part **G142**, the threshold used for determining whether calibration is to be executed can be determined by threshold adjustment bars being slid from side to side.

(84) As described above, with the GUIs for presenting output result of acquiring the amount of change and the parameter input for calibration, intuitive recognition of the user can be facilitated, whereby usability regarding the correction of the relative position/orientation can further be improved.

(85) In the first and the second exemplary embodiments, when the movement control is performed to cause a predetermined movement of the vehicle **10** such as straight movement and turn, the amount of change in the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** is acquired

based on the position/orientation of the sensor **12**, and the relative position/orientation is corrected based on the amount of change. The description on each of the first and the second exemplary embodiments is given assuming that the vehicle **10** is an unmanned carrier that moves on the ground, that is, a two-dimensional plane. Thus, the degree-of-freedom of the position/orientation of the vehicle **10** is three (two position parameters and one orientation parameter).

(86) In a fourth exemplary embodiment, a description is given of a case of application to a vehicle such as a drone that can move and rotate in the height direction (orthogonal to the floor in the real space). Thus, in the fourth exemplary embodiment, a method of correcting the relative position/orientation when the drone moves along a straight line movement trail is described. The degree-of-freedom of the position/orientation of such a vehicle **10** is six (three position parameters and three orientation parameters).

(87) The system configuration example according to the present exemplary embodiment is the same as that in the first exemplary embodiment, and includes the information processing device **11** and the vehicle **10** including the sensor **12** as illustrated in FIG. **1**. However, there is a difference in that the vehicle **10** can move not in the horizontal direction but also in the vertical direction. Furthermore, there are differences in that the number of orientation parameters of the vehicle **10**, which is one (yaw) in the first exemplary embodiment, is three (roll, pitch, yaw) in the present exemplary embodiment, and in that rotation about the three axes X, Y, and Z can be performed. Here, the Z axis is a coordinate axis in the direction orthogonal to the floor in the real space, and roll and pitch are defined as orientation parameters representing rotation about the X axis and the Y axis, respectively. The hardware configuration according to the present exemplary embodiment is the same as that in the first exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. **3**. The functions of each hardware are the same as those in the first exemplary embodiment and thus the description thereof is omitted. FIG. **12** is a diagram illustrating a processing procedure according to the present exemplary embodiment. Processing procedures different from those in the first exemplary embodiment will be described, and description on the other procedures, which are regarded as being the same as those in FIG. **4**, will be omitted.

(88) The drone can move three-dimensionally, and in the present exemplary embodiment, moves along the X axis, the Y axis, and the Z axis in this order. Here, the order of the coordinate axes along which the movement occurs may be any order. A flowchart in FIG. **12** illustrates the processing procedure for each axis.

(89) In step **S401**, the movement control unit **111** determines a route and a stop point for the movement of the drone, and generates control information. The drone is likely to wobble when moving forward, backward, left, and right, and thus is difficult to move straight. In the present exemplary embodiment, the following movement trail of the vehicle **10** is regarded as a straight line. A stop point, where the drone hovers or lands to stabilize, is provided in the middle of the movement route. The position/orientation of the sensor **12** at this point is used to create a pseudo straightened movement trail. The straightening is obtaining an approximate straight line movement trail easily using a method of excluding position measurement data deviated from the straight line or a method of averaging a group of position measurement data pieces including fluctuations.

(90) In step **S102**, the movement control unit **111** moves the drone using the control information generated in step **S401** as an input. In this process, the drone is temporarily stopped at the stop point.

(91) In step **S103**, the position/orientation estimation unit **112** estimates the position/orientation of the sensor **12** around the stop point, and outputs an average value as a result of the estimation to the position/orientation conversion unit **113**.

(92) In step **S104**, the position/orientation conversion unit **113** converts the trail of the position/orientation of the sensor **12** input by the position/orientation estimation unit **112** from the sensor coordinate system to the vehicle coordinate system. In the first exemplary embodiment, the six position/orientation parameters are reduced to three position/orientation parameters as the

degree-of-freedom on the vehicle coordinate system is three. On the other hand, the vehicle **10** according to the present exemplary embodiment has six degrees-of-freedom and thus the parameters are not reduced.

(93) In step **S105**, the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** uses the position information about the sensor **12** at the start point and the stop point input by the position/orientation conversion unit **113** to acquire an amount of change between the relative position/orientation held in the RAM **H13** and the actual physical relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12**. The vehicle **10** moves straight and thus an amount of change in the orientation parameter of the relative position/orientation can be found, but the rotation component in the amount of change obtained depending on the movement direction. Specifically, for movement along the X, Y, and Z axes, rotation components pitch, yaw, and roll are respectively obtained from the position information. The method as in the first exemplary embodiment may be directly used to calculate the amount of change regardless of the movement direction. In the case of Z axis movement, the moving direction and the coordinate axis orthogonal thereto in the first exemplary embodiment are respectively replaced by the Z axis and the Y axis, and the comparison target axis for obtaining the amount of change is replaced with the Z axis. As a result, the amount of change in the orientation parameter Roll is an angle between the Z axis and the approximate straight line obtained using the position information about the sensor **12**. On the other hand, in the case of X axis movement, the moving direction and the coordinate axis orthogonal thereto in the first exemplary embodiment are respectively replaced by the X axis and the Z axis, and the comparison target axis for obtaining the amount of change is replaced with the X axis. Thus, the amount of change in the orientation parameter Pitch is an angle between the X axis and the approximate straight line obtained using the position information about the sensor **12**.

(94) In step **S108**, the relative position/orientation calibration unit **116** corrects the relative position/orientation to make it match the actual physical relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the sensor **12**, based on the amount of change in the relative position/orientation acquired by the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. The relative position/orientation is corrected by subtracting the amounts of change in the three orientation parameters obtained in step **S105** from the components of the relative position/orientation.

(95) In the fourth exemplary embodiment, the relative position/orientation of the sensor **12** and the vehicle **10** for the vehicle **10** movable in any direction in the three-dimensional space can be corrected without using a highly accurate movement amount of the vehicle **10**. Thus, the change in the relative positional relationship between the vehicle **10** and the position/orientation estimation device can be easily corrected.

(96) (Modification 4-1)

(97) In the fourth exemplary embodiment, the movement control unit **111** moves the drone along the X, Y, and Z coordinate axes. However, the movement direction is not limited to that, and may be any direction as long as the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** can compare the predicted position of the sensor **12** with the position of the vehicle **10**, even if the movement direction is not along any of the coordinate axes. The amount-of-change acquisition unit **114** determines a reference two-dimensional plane, and then compares the predicted position of the sensor **12** and the position of the vehicle **10**. The reference two-dimensional plane is determined depending on the rotation component of the amount of change to be acquired. Specifically, the rotation component to be acquired is on an XY plane for Yaw, a YZ plane for Roll, and a ZX plane for Pitch. For example, to acquire the amount of change in the rotation component Roll, the movement control unit **111** makes the vehicle **10** move straight on the YZ plane, and compares the predicted position of the sensor **12** with the position of the vehicle **10**. Furthermore, when the vehicle **10** is moved in any direction in the XYZ space other than on the YZ plane, the amount of change in Pitch may be acquired by projecting the predicted position of the sensor **12** and the position of the vehicle **10** on the YZ plane, and comparing the position information pieces after the projection on the plane.

(98) (Modification 4-2)

(99) In the fourth exemplary embodiment, the position/orientation estimation unit **112** estimates the position/orientation of the sensor **12** around the stop point, and outputs the average value as a result of the estimation. However, this should not be understood in a limiting sense, and any estimation result may be output as long as the estimation result is obtained from a straightened line with the group of positions/orientations. In other embodiments, the drone immediately after the start of the movement is likely to wobble, and thus, the position/orientation is estimated at constant time intervals after a predetermined time period elapses after the start of the movement. Alternatively, the position/orientation may be estimated at constant distance intervals after the drone has moved by a predetermined distance after the start of the movement to be output to the amount-of-change acquisition unit **114**. Furthermore, the position/orientation deviated from the straight line may be excluded regardless of the distance or time after the start of movement.

(100) (Modification 4-3)

(101) In the fourth exemplary embodiment, the movement control unit **111** corrects the three orientation parameters of the relative position/orientation by moving a vehicle straight in each direction along the X axis, the Y axis, and the Z axis. Alternatively, the three position parameters of the relative position/orientation may be corrected by turning a vehicle about the individual coordinate axes in order, instead of moving the vehicle straight. Here, the turning may be implemented by a movement control method of rotating the drone in the air, or a method of turning the drone fixed to a jig so as to rotate about a design turning axis. The position parameter that can be corrected varies among the turning axes, as in the case of the straight movement. Specifically, Y and Z coordinates, Z and X coordinates, and X and Y coordinates can be corrected through an X axis rotation (roll), Y axis rotation (pitch), and Z axis rotation (yaw), respectively. A method that is the same as that in the second exemplary embodiment can be used to acquire the amount of change and perform calibration for the turning. For example, in a case of rotation about the X axis, the two-dimensional plane onto which the position information is mapped according to the second exemplary embodiment is replaced with the YZ plane. The amount of change in the position parameter Y and Z coordinates is a difference between the center coordinates of the approximate circle obtained using the position information about the sensor **12** and the initial position coordinates (origin).

(102) (Modification 4-4)

(103) In the fourth exemplary embodiment, the position/orientation of the sensor **12** around the stop point is used to acquire the amount of change as the drone is difficult to stably move straight. This is not limited to drones. For example, this can be applied to vehicles such as unmanned carriers, autonomous driving vehicles, or autonomously moving robots, all of which move on a two-dimensional plane.

(104) (Modification 4-5)

(105) In Modification 4-2, the position/orientation estimation unit **112** excludes the position/orientation deviated from the straight line to obtain a straight line from a group of estimated positions/orientations of the sensor **12**. This is not limited to drones. For example, this can be applied to vehicles such as unmanned carriers, autonomous driving vehicles, or autonomously moving robots, all of which move on a two-dimensional plane.

(106) Of the above-mentioned processing units, the position/orientation measurement unit **112** and the movement control unit **111** may be replaced by a machine-learned trained model to execute the processing. In this case, for example, a plurality of combinations of input data and output data to the processing units is prepared as training data, and a trained model is generated that acquires knowledge from such data through machine learning, and as a result, and output output data corresponding to the input data based on the acquired knowledge. The trained model can be, for example, a neural network model. Then, the trained model executes the processing of the processing units by cooperating with a CPU, a GPU, or the like as a program for executing the

processing that is the same as that executed by the processing units. The trained model may be updated after certain processing as appropriate.

(107) Other Embodiments

(108) Embodiment(s) of the disclosure can also be realized by a computer of a system or apparatus that reads out and executes computer executable instructions (e.g., one or more programs) recorded on a storage medium (which may also be referred to more fully as a ‘non-transitory computer-readable storage medium’) to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s) and/or that includes one or more circuits (e.g., application specific integrated circuit (ASIC)) for performing the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s), and by a method performed by the computer of the system or apparatus by, for example, reading out and executing the computer executable instructions from the storage medium to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s) and/or controlling the one or more circuits to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s). The computer may comprise one or more processors (e.g., central processing unit (CPU), micro processing unit (MPU)) and may include a network of separate computers or separate processors to read out and execute the computer executable instructions. The computer executable instructions may be provided to the computer, for example, from a network or the storage medium. The storage medium may include, for example, one or more of a hard disk, a random-access memory (RAM), a read only memory (ROM), a storage of distributed computing systems, an optical disk (such as a compact disc (CD), digital versatile disc (DVD), or Blu-ray Disc (BD)TM), a flash memory device, a memory card, and the like.

(109) While the disclosure has been described with reference to exemplary embodiments, it is to be understood that the disclosure is not limited to the disclosed exemplary embodiments. The scope of the following claims is to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass all such modifications and equivalent structures and functions.

(110) This application claims the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2020-027743, filed Feb. 21, 2020, which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

Claims

1. A device comprising: at least one processor; and a memory coupled to the at least one processor, the memory having instructions that, when executed by the processor, causes the at least one processor to function as: an estimation unit configured to estimate, when a vehicle provided with a sensor makes a predetermined movement, first position information indicating positions of the vehicle based on input information of the sensor and an orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle; and an acquisition unit configured to acquire second position information indicating expected positions of the vehicle corresponding to the predetermined movement while maintaining an original orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle held by a holding unit; an output unit configured to output an amount of change between the orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle when the vehicle has performed the predetermined movement and the original orientation, based on the first position information and the second position information, wherein a control is performed to cause the orientation of the sensor to change by the amount of change.
2. The device according to claim 1, wherein the output unit outputs output information indicating a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information.
3. The device according to claim 1, wherein the output unit outputs output information indicating that the orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle is the predetermined orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle, when a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information is smaller than a predetermined threshold.
4. The device according to claim 1, wherein the output unit outputs output information indicating

that the orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle is not the predetermined orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle, when a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information is equal to or greater than a predetermined threshold.

5. The device according to claim 1, wherein the output unit outputs, to a display device, output information indicating that the orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle is not the predetermined orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle, when a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information is equal to or greater than a predetermined threshold.

6. The device according to claim 1, wherein the output unit outputs output information to make a display device display the position of the vehicle indicated by the first or the second position information, when a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information is equal to or greater than a predetermined threshold.

7. The device according to claim 1, wherein the output unit outputs, to an audio output device, output information indicating that the orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle is not the predetermined orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle, when a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information is equal to or greater than a predetermined threshold.

8. The device according to claim 1, wherein the output unit outputs, to a projection device or a display device, output information indicating the orientation of the sensor corresponding to the predetermined orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle, when a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information is larger than a predetermined value.

9. The device according to claim 1, wherein the output unit outputs output information differing depending on a magnitude of a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information based on a plurality of thresholds.

10. The device according to claim 8, wherein the output unit outputs output information to a first output device when the difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information is larger than a first threshold, and outputs the output information to a second output device when the difference in the position of the vehicle between the first position information and the second position information is larger than a second threshold that is smaller than the first threshold.

11. The device according to claim 1, wherein the predetermined movement is a movement of the vehicle moving straight by a predetermined distance, and wherein the output unit outputs output information indicating a change in an orientation of the sensor based on a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information.

12. The device according to claim 1, wherein the predetermined movement is a movement of the vehicle turning by a predetermined angle, and wherein the output unit outputs output information indicating a change in a position of the sensor based on a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information.

13. The device according to claim 1, wherein the at least one processor further functions as an update unit configured to update the orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle based on output information, when a difference in the position of the vehicle based on the first position information and the second position information is larger than a predetermined threshold.

14. The device according to claim 1, wherein the at least one processor further functions as a measurement unit configured to measure a position of the sensor from the input information, based on map information obtained by measuring a movement route of the vehicle in advance, and wherein the estimation unit estimates the position of the vehicle by converting the measured position or orientation of the sensor, based on the predetermined orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle.

15. The device according to claim 1, wherein the sensor is an image capturing device that captures an image of an object in an environment.

16. The device according to claim 1, wherein the sensor is a range sensor that measures a distance between an object in an environment and the sensor.

17. A method comprising: estimating, when a vehicle provided with a sensor makes a predetermined movement, first position information indicating positions of the vehicle based on input information of the sensor and an orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle; and acquiring second position information indicating expected positions of the vehicle corresponding to the predetermined movement while maintaining an original orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle held by a holding unit; outputting an amount of change in a between the orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle when the vehicle has performed the predetermined movement and the original orientation, based on the first position information and the second position information, wherein a control is performed to cause the sensor to change by the amount of change.

18. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing a computer executable program for causing a computer to perform a method, the method comprising: estimating, when a vehicle provided with a sensor makes a predetermined movement, first position information indicating positions of the vehicle based on input information of the sensor and an orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle; and acquiring second position information indicating expected positions of the vehicle corresponding to the predetermined movement while maintaining an original orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle held by a holding unit; outputting an amount of change between the orientation of the sensor relative to the vehicle when the vehicle has performed the predetermined movement and the original orientation, based on the first position information and the second position information, wherein a control is performed to cause the sensor to change by the amount of change.

19. The device according to claim 1, wherein the at least one processor further functions as an acquisition unit configured to acquire the second position information indicating a trail of the vehicle corresponding to the predetermined movement, and wherein the output unit outputs the vehicle based on the second position information acquired by the acquisition unit.

20. The device according to claim 1, wherein the first position information indicates a trail of the amount of change from the predetermined orientation of the sensor based on the sensor information.
